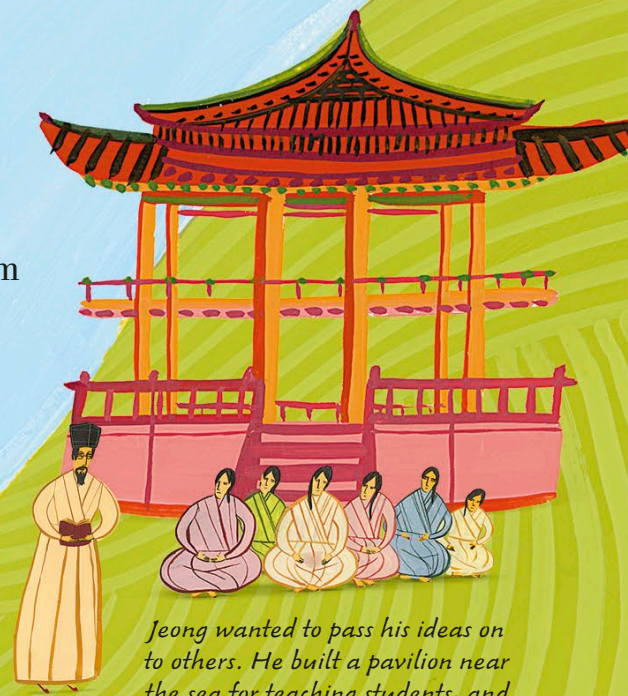


Excelling in exile

Disaster struck when King Jeongjo died in 1800. The new queen regent used Jeong's interest in outside ideas as an excuse to banish him from the royal palace. For 18 years, Jeong lived in exile in a tiny, cramped room, but he didn't stop studying and writing. In fact, he worked harder than ever! He was especially interested in finding ways to tackle poverty and help the poorest Koreans, including farmers. Today's scientists are still learning from Jeong's approach to data and how he used it to solve big, practical problems.



Jeong wanted to pass his ideas on to others. He built a pavilion near the sea for teaching students, and for sharing tea!



In exile, Jeong brewed tea outdoors on top of a flat rock. He experimented with different ways of preparing the leaves. One of his favorite methods was to squash them into a solid lump, to be mixed with boiling water.

"Dasan" means "mountain of tea."

Terrific tea

Jeong was interested in the science of tea, and he believed that tea improved his health. He also learned about the cultural traditions and rituals for preparing and tasting it. He worked closely with local Buddhists on a plan to plant new tea trees in southwest Korea.

